§ **354.** Like **ende** are declined **esne,** *servant;* **hierde,** *shepherd;* **hwǣte,** *wheat;* **lǣce,** *physician;* **mēce,** *sword;* and the nomina agentis, as **bǣcere,** *baker;* **biddere,** *petitioner;* **bōcere,** *scribe;* **sǣdere,** *sower;* for further examples see § **602.**

§ **355.** *Neuter.*

SING.			
Nom. Acc.	**cyn(n),** *race*	**wīte,** *punishment*	**wēsten,** *desert*
Gen.	**cynnes**	**wītes**	**wēstennes**
Dat.	**cynne**	**wīte**	**wēstenne**
PLUR.			
Nom. Acc.	**cyn(n)**	**wītu**	**wēstennu**
Gen.	**cynna**	**wīta**	**wēstenna**
Dat.	**cynnum**	**wītum**	**wēstennum**

As in the masc. **ja**-stems it is necessary to distinguish between those stems which were originally long and those which became long by the West Germanic doubling of consonants (§ **254**). The neuter **ja**-stems had the same endings as the masculine except in the nom. acc. plural. The nom. acc. plural ended in prim. Germanic in **-jō** which became **-ju** in prim. OE. The **j** regularly disappeared after causing umlaut of the preceding vowel. And then the **-u** being preceded by a long syllable also disappeared **215**). The nom. acc. pl. of the originally short stems is regularly developed from the prim. Germanic form, as **cyn(n)** from ***kunjō.** But the **-u** in the originally long stems and in words containing a suffix is not the preservation of the prim. OE. **-u.** Such nouns owe their final **-u** to the analogy of the nom. acc. pl. of short **a**-stems (§ **342**). That forms like **wītu, wēstennu** are new formations is proved by the simple fact that from a Germanic point of view these nouns ought to have the same ending in OE. as the nom. acc. singular of the **jō**-stems (§ **374**).

The OE. forms with double consonants in the nom. acc. singular are all new formations from the inflected forms, as **cyn(n), bedd, nett** for ***cyne**, ***bede**, ***nete** = Goth. **kuni, badi, nati,** see § **274.** On the final double consonants in the nom. acc. singular, see § **259.** In late OE. the double consonants in words containing a suffix were generally simplified in the inflected forms, and the medial vowel was also occasionally syncopated, as gen. **wēstenes,** pl. **wēstenu,** beside **wēstnu.**

§ **356.** Like **cyn(n)** are declined **bedd,** *bed*; **bill,** *sword*; **denn,** *den*; **flett,** *floor*; **giedd,** *song*; **nebb,** *beak*; **nett,** *net*; **ribb,** *rib*; **webb,** *web*; **wedd,** *pledge*; **wicg,** *horse*; **witt,** *understanding.*

§ **357.** Like **wīte** are declined **ǣrende,** *errand*; **fēþe,** *walking, power of motion*; **ierfe,** *inheritance*; **ierre,** *anger*; **rīce,** *kingdom*; **rȳne,** *mystery*; **stīele,** *steel*; **wǣge,** *cup*; nouns with the prefix **ge-**, as **gefilde,** *plain*; **gefylce,** *troop*; **getīeme,** *yoke* (*of oxen*), *team*; **getimbre,** *building*; **gemierce,** *boundary*; **gewǣde,** *dress, clothing*; **geþīode, geþēode,** *language.* **flicce,** prim. Germanic ***flikkja-**, *flitch*; **stycce,** prim. Germanic ***stukkja-**, *piece.* See § **270,** Note, on nouns like **hīeg** (Goth. **hawi**), *hay,* **hīew, hīw** (Goth. **hiwi**), *shape, appearance,* **glīg, glīw** (Goth. ***gliwi**), *glee,* gen. **hīeges, hīewes** (**hīowes**), **glīges, glīwes.**

§ **358.** Like **wēsten** are declined **fæsten(n),** *fortress,* cp. § **600**; **bærnet(t),** *arson*; **nierwet(t),** *narrowness*; **sǣwet(t),** *sowing*; **þēowet(t),** *slavery*; for further examples, see § **604.** To this class probably also belong the diminutives in **-incel,** which generally syncopate the **e** in the inflected forms, as **cofincel,** *little chamber,* gen. **cofincles**; and similarly **hæftincel,** *slave*; **hūsincel,** *little house*; **scipincel,** *little ship*; **sūlincel,** *small furrow*; for further examples, see § **606.** **fiþere,** *wing.*

c. wa-STEMS.

§ **359.** *Masculine.*

SING.		
Nom. Acc.	**bearu, -o,** *grove*	**þēo,** *servant*
Gen.	**bearwes**	**þeowes**
Dat.	**bearwe**	**þeowe**
PLUR.		
Nom. Acc.	**bearwas**	**þeowas**
Gen.	**bearwa**	**þeowa**
Dat.	**bearwum**	**þeowum**

In the inflected forms the masc. **wa**-stems have the same endings as the pure **a**-stems. After the loss of prim. Germanic **-az, -an** in the nom. and acc. singular, the **w** being final became vocalized to **-u** which remained after short vowels followed by a consonant, but with a preceding short vowel it combined to form a diphthong (§§ **264–5**); thus prim. Germanic ***þarwaz, -an,** ***þewaz, -an** regularly became **bearu** (later **bearo**), **þēo.** After a long vowel the **-u** regularly disappeared, as in **snā,** *snow,* from ***snaiwaz, -an.** At a later period the **w** in the inflected forms was levelled out into the nom. acc. singular, whence **þēow, snāw** beside older **þēo, snā.** And then from **þēow** there was often formed a new gen. **þēowes** beside the regular form **þeowes** (§ **265**). On forms like gen. **bearuwes** beside **bearwes,** see § **220.**

§ **360.** Like **þēo, þēow** are declined **bēaw,** *gadfly*; **dēaw** (also neut.), *dew*; **lārēow** from **lād** + **þēow,** *teacher*; **lāttēow** from **lād** + **þēow,** *leader*; **þēaw,** *custom*; **brīw** (Goth. ***breiws**), *pottage, porridge*; **gīw, gēow,** *griffin, vulture*; **īw, īow, ēow,** *yew*; **slīw** (Goth. ***sleiws**), *tench* (*a fish*).

§ **361.** *Neuter.*

SING.		
Nom. Acc.	**bealu, -o,** *evil*	**cnēo,** *knee*
Gen.	**bealwes**	**cneowes**
Dat.	**bealwe**	**cneowe**
PLUR.		
Nom. Acc.	**bealu, -o**	**cnēo**
Gen.	**bealwa**	**cneowa**
Dat.	**bealwum**	**cneowum**

The neuter **wa**-stems have the same endings as the masculine except in the nom. acc. plural. What has been said in § **359** about the history of the **w** also applies to the neuters. It should be noted that the nom. acc. plural **bealu, cnēo** are from older ***beal(w)u,** ***kne(w)u** (§ **266**), whereas the nom. acc. sing. **bealu, cnēo,** are from older ***bealw-,** ***knew-** (§ **265**). On the svarabhakti vowel in the inflected forms like gen. **bealuwes** beside **bealwes,** see § **220.** Besides the regular nom. acc. pl. **cnēo,** there also occurs **cnēow** with **w** from the inflected forms; and also **cnĕowu** with **-u** from forms like **bealu.** In late OE. the pl. also ended in **-wa.**

§ **362.** Like **bealu** are declined **c(w)udu,** *cud*; **teoru,** *tar*; **meolu, melu,** *meal, flour*; **searu,** *device*; **smeoru,** *fat.*

§ **363.** Like **cnēo, cnēow** are also declined **anclēow** (orig. masc.), *ankle*; **bēow,** *barley*; **gehlōw,** *lowing, bellowing*; **gehrēow,** *lamentation*; **hlēo(w),** *protection, covering*; **sēaw** (also masc.), *juice*; **strēa(w),** *straw*; **trēo(w),** *tree.*

2. THE **ō**-DECLENSION.

§ **364.** The **ō**-declension contains feminine nouns only, and corresponds to the Latin and Greek **ā**-declension, for which reason it is sometimes called the **ā**-declension. The **ō**-declension is divided into pure **ō**-stems, **jō**-stems, and **wō**-stems.